Cayman Feeder Onboarding SOP — Joint Non-US Institutional Signers

Client Operations playbook · Version 1.0 of 6 May 2025 · Owner: Minh Nguyen · Derived from CASE-2025-014

This SOP covers onboarding of non-US entity limited partners that execute through two or more joint authorised signers into a Cayman Islands feeder fund on FundSub. It applies wherever the subscription agreement allocates tax elections to a single signatory. It does not restate FATCA, the CRS or Cayman Islands law: the role split below implements the fund's own subscription agreement, and the administrator remains responsible for reviewing tax forms.

Section 1. Scope and Roles

Role	Who	Can edit	Signs
`SUBSCRIPTION_OWNER`	LP's onboarding contact	Investor details, Annex B designation	Nothing
`PRIMARY_TAX_COLLABORATOR`	The Designated Tax Signatory named in Annex B	W-8BEN-E Part I line 5, GIIN, Parts XXV/XXVI/XXIX, CRS classification and Controlling Persons	W-8BEN-E Part XXX; CRS self-certification
`CO_SIGNER`	Every other joint signatory	Own attestation only	Annex B paragraph 3 acknowledgement
Administrator	Fund administrator's onboarding team	Nothing	Review only

Section 2. Kickoff Checklist (Week 1)

(a) Obtain the final-form subscription agreement and locate the joint-signatory clause and its annex. In CASE-2025-014 these were Section 4.3(b)–(d) and Annex B.

(b) Confirm in writing with fund counsel which signatory makes the Chapter 4 and CRS elections, and whether other signatories sign Part XXX or only an acknowledgement.

(c) Map those answers onto the roles in Section 1 and record them in the form specification before any build starts.

(d) Start from the `cayman_fatca_v2.json` schema. Change parameters only (jurisdiction, IGA model, reporting channel, maximum joint signers); never change field ownership or the committed-state evaluation.

(e) Agree with the administrator that a CRS classification is never used to prefill the FATCA Chapter 4 status.

Section 3. Build Rules

- Conditional logic (`visibleWhen`, `requiredWhen`) reads committed state only. Two signers on one account must always see the same form.
- No step-wide locks. Step 4 completes on valid committed tax data plus one attestation per co-signer.

- One DocuSign anchor per recipient per signature location: `\ch4_primary_sig\` for the primary, `\cosigner_N_attest\` for each co-signer.
- Annex B must designate exactly one Designated Tax Signatory; zero or two designations block Step 1.
- A FATCA/CRS classification mismatch is a warning for the administrator, never a hard block.

Section 4. UAT Script

Run `w8bene_joint_entity_exception_matrix.csv` in full. For every scenario:

(a) open two or three browser sessions, one per signer, at the same time;

(b) run each scenario twice, once with the primary opening Step 4 first and once with a co-signer opening it first;

(c) run the envelope pre-flight for every signer count from 1 to the configured maximum; and

(d) have the administrator review one generated W-8BEN-E per Chapter 4 status before sign-off.

Note: in CASE-2025-014 pre-UAT testing used one tester driving each signer in turn. The co-signer-first deadlock only reproduces with concurrent sessions.

Section 5. Go-Live and Change Control

Gate	Owner	Evidence
Role mapping approved	Fund counsel	Email confirming Section 2(b)
Exception matrix green	QA	All 16 scenarios, both signer orders
Administrator review	Administrator	One accepted W-8BEN-E per Chapter 4 status
Draft reset plan	Client Operations	List of test drafts to purge before go-live

If the Designated Tax Signatory changes after go-live, the subscription agreement normally requires notice signed by all joint signatories with an updated Annex B. Re-run Step 4 for that LP only; never merge co-signer drafts into the primary's committed elections.

Section 6. Lessons from CASE-2025-014

- The deadlock cost a 9-day slip of UAT sign-off and the initial close across 14 joint-signer LPs. The patch took one night; the slip came from re-running the administrator's UAT over the Cayman Easter holidays.
- Budget two extra administrator UAT days whenever the role model changes after UAT has started.
- Ask at kickoff, not in UAT, who owns each tax election.